Dennis G. Pezan

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Education

United States Military Academy at West Point — West Point, NY
B.S., Operations Research (Finance Specialization), Minor in Artificial Intelligence — Class of 2029

- CQPA: 3.571 | Dean's List, Fall 2025 and Spring 2026 | Secret Clearance
- **Stokes Writing Fellowship** – endowed fellowship funding research travel, expert mentorship, and publication of original research
- **Sea to Shining Sea Fellowship** – engages cadets with senior leaders in national security, government, finance, and technology

Research Experience

MIT Center for Transportation & Logistics – USMA Research — West Point, NY
Undergraduate Researcher, Network Interdiction for Contested Logistics (Advisor: LTC Matthew Webb) — 2026–Present

- Study how to attack and defend military logistics networks using network optimization, game theory, and Markov decision processes
- Built a 57-node, 79-edge model of Taiwan's crude oil imports with seven costed adversary actions, verified by independent max-flow

Transformation Decision Analysis Center (TDAC), U.S. Army — Fort Lee, VA
Research Intern, Modeling & Analysis Division — Summer 2026

- Redesigned the reward function for a PPO reinforcement-learning agent in the Army's Logistics Battle Command simulation
- Diagnosed four reward flaws; the retrained agent more than tripled requests filled and beat a priority-aware baseline over 101 seeds
- Presented findings to Branch Chief LTC Ryan Miller and, by call, to TDAC's AI/RL researchers at the Naval Postgraduate School

Department of Mathematical Sciences, USMA — West Point, NY
Independent Study in Machine Learning (MA289), Advisor: LTC Patrick Kuiper — 2025–2026

- Designed and completed an independent study of decision trees, bagging, and random forests; presented the findings to officers

Projects

Tree-Based Methods Research Site — dennis-pezan.com/ma289.html

- Compared decision trees, bagging, and random forests on Titanic data (scikit-learn) by tree correlation and overfitting

CFT Packing List – Web Application — dennis-pezan.com/cft.html

- Web tool that helps cadets organize and track gear for Cadet Field Training; deployed on Vercel from GitHub

Professional Development

Sea to Shining Sea Domestic AIAD — California and Colorado
Defense Technology and Innovation — Summer 2026

- Discussed how defense technology is built, bought, and fielded with leaders at Palantir, Gordian Knot, OpenAI, Apple, and Meta
- Observed how the 4th Infantry Division and U.S. Northern Command use these systems

Leadership & Activities

Center for Enhanced Performance — West Point, NY
Cadet-in-Charge, MA103 Tutoring — 2026–Present

- Lead the full tutor staff for MA103 (1,010 cadets), covering every major graded event; certified tutor since 2025

Mounger Writing Center – *Writing Consultant* — 2026–Present

- Selected as a Stokes Writing Fellow to coach cadets on strengthening the rhetoric and argument of their writing

CLD-STEM Outreach Program – *Member* — 2025–Present

- Bring hands-on STEM projects to 800+ students across the Chicagoland and Greater Los Angeles areas

Cadet Ambassador Program – *Cadet Ambassador* — 2025–Present

- Represent West Point in outreach to prospective cadets

McDonald's — Plainfield, IL
Department Manager — September 2022 – July 2024

- Promoted at 16 as the region's youngest department manager; scheduled 80+ staff, ran $20K+ weekly orders, kept labor at or below 23.5%

Skills

Python (PyTorch, scikit-learn), SQL, Java | Reinforcement learning, network optimization | Spanish (fluent)